

COMPANION TO THE ANGLER'S FIELD GUIDE • HAKAI
PASS 2026

Film Room

Sixteen videos that teach the hands-on fishing skills the field guide can only describe. Watch before you fly: **there is no cell service at the lodge**, and the videos need internet.

Watch these three, in this order

Roughly 30–50 minutes of video. Aim to have all three watched before your bags are packed.



WATCH 1 • THE EVERY-HOUR SKILL

Down-Rigging 101 — Tutorial for Beginners

Hunt Fish Maniac • 2021 • BC-based

Full beginner walkthrough of the gear you will run every hour of every day — clip tension, deploying, clearing. Watch before you touch the Scotty on day one.

GUIDE \$4

☐ watched



WATCH 2 • THE SIGNATURE BAIT

How to Rig a Cut Plug Herring for Salmon Fishing

Baranof Fishing Excursions • 2021 • SE Alaska

A charter captain's step-by-step of the trip's signature bait: the beveled head cut, the tandem-hook rig, and checking the roll boat-side — exactly the \$6 method. Watch it, then practice the cut dockside on night one.

GUIDE \$6

☐ watched



WATCH 3 • THE UNREPEATABLE MOMENT

How to Net a Spring Chinook Salmon

Fishing with David Pyle • 2017

Boat-based netting walkthrough — net-man positioning, leading the fish, the two-person endgame. The one moment of the trip you cannot retry; both people in the boat should watch it.

GUIDE \$5 • \$9

☐ watched

Room for more? Add the sounder-basics pick or the halibut rig below, depending on your weak spot.

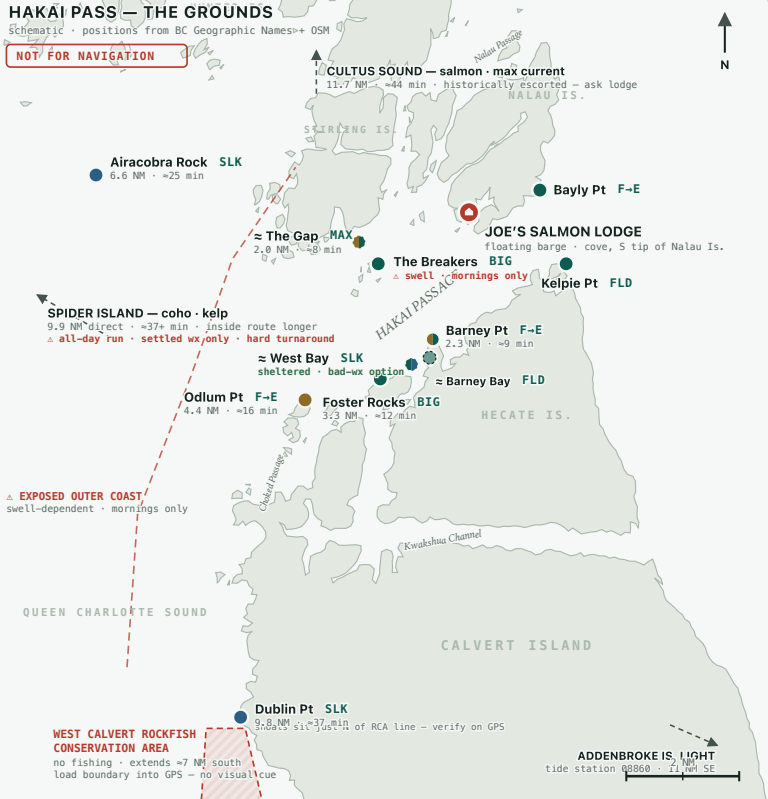
The grounds, at a glance

A schematic copy of the field guide's planning map, for orienting the videos' techniques to real water. Full detail, run times and tide keys are in the guide, Section 3.

HAKAI PASS — THE GROUNDS

schematic · positions from BC Geographic Names+ OSM

NOT FOR NAVIGATION



● chinook-first ● coho / salmon ● bottomfish

⊙ ≈ approximate — confirm with lodge

Tide keys (from the structure table): F→E last 2 h flood → first h ebb · MAX mid-flood / mid-ebb · BIG any moving water, best big tide · FLD flood + top of tide · SLK ±1 h of slack

Half-and-half dots carry two fisheries. Run times assume 16 kn straight-line — inside routes run longer. Positions verified against BC Geographic Names / OSM; dashed ≈ marks are inference, and **Bald Rock could not be located at all** — get both from the lodge with GPS waypoints. Chart spellings: **Bayly Point**, **Airacobra Rock**, **Cultus Sound**. RCA boundary from DFO's published West Calvert coordinates — confirm the current season's before you fish. Schematic — **not for navigation**.

Bait work

GUIDE §6

Cut-plug and brine — the disciplines that separate guided results from unguided ones.



Rolling Herring — Everything You Need to Know

The Guides Guide · 2024

A recent deep-dive devoted to one thing: getting the barrel roll right. This is the §6 “check the roll before you send it down” discipline, taught.

ALTERNATE CUT-PLUG



Plug Cut Herring for Puget Sound Salmon

WA Fish Quest · 2022 · Puget Sound

Brine → cut → rig in one continuous sequence — the closest verified match to the guide’s overnight salt-brine workflow. (No video was verified showing the powdered-milk trick specifically; that stays a guide-only detail.)

BRINING

Downriggers, stacking, blowback

GUIDE §4

The 2026 two-layer rig lives or dies on these mechanics.



Downrigger Stacking Techniques **— Northwest Fishing Tips**

Northwest Fishing · ~2021 · PNW

A dedicated demo of putting a second rod on the same cable — the exact stacking skill §4 asks you to run 80–100 ft above the ball. The most directly trip-relevant video on this page after the syllabus.

CORE SKILL



Scotty — How to Use a Downrigger

Scotty Fishing & Outdoor Products · 2023 · BC manufacturer

The maker's own explainer for the exact brand on most BC lodge boats. Clean fundamentals to pair with Down-Rigging 101.

ALTERNATE

WORTH KNOWING

No video is *dedicated* to blowback or the flasher-rotation speed check — both are touched on inside the 101-style videos above. The working numbers: at 100 ft expect true depth 15–25% shallower than the counter reads, and a flasher is at correct speed when it rotates a full continuous 360°.

Reading the sounder GUIDE §4

The primary instrument of a heatwave year: thermocline, bait balls, manual gain.



Sounder Tips for Finding Bait Balls

Spooled Magazine · 2022 · saltwater (AU)

Genuinely saltwater screen-reading — manual gain and bait-ball identification. The target species is marlin, but the skill of seeing soft returns transfers directly to finding Hakai's thin, patchy bait.



How to Read a Fishfinder — What to Look For

Flukemaster · 2024

The best verified fundamentals course — arches, gain, and thermocline banding — though it leans freshwater. Between the two, everything §4 asks of the sounder is covered.

FUNDAMENTALS

THE ONE HOLE IN THIS SYLLABUS

No good BC/PNW *saltwater-salmon* sounder tutorial seems to exist. These two picks jointly cover the required skills; apply them with the guide's salmon-specific notes (§4: thermocline as a faint band, bait at or below it, fish the arches at the edges).

Fighting and landing big chinook

GUIDE §5 · §9

The netting half is in the syllabus (Watch 3). This is the fighting half.



Fishing Tips — How to Fight Big Fish (and Win the Battle)

Capt. Chris Myers · 2018 · saltwater

Drag management, rod angles, letting runs happen — the discipline for the “slow, heavy, unstoppable” fish the guide’s ten-second ID table tells you is a spring. Not salmon-specific, but the best verified treatment of the mechanics.

WORTH KNOWING

No single video covers fight-plus-net of a big saltwater chinook from a small boat; this video and Watch 3 together cover both halves.

Halibut, lingcod, rockfish release

GUIDE §7 · §2

Spreader bars, jigging, and the descending device the regulations expect you to use.



Halibut Rigs — Circle Hook and Spreader Bar Setup

FishinBC.com · 2013 · BC

Exact match to the §7 rig — spreader bar, circle hook, don't set the hook. A classic, and still the definitive BC version.

PRIMARY



"How-To" Halibut Rigging (A to Z)

Fish Hunt Northwest · 2020 · Puget Sound

A fuller A-to-Z rigging session — good second angle on hardware and bait choices (remember §7: ask the lodge to save your salmon bellies).

ALTERNATE



How to Vertically Jig Big Lingcod

VIP Outdoors · Oregon coast

Jig cadence, staying vertical, and the hit-on-the-drop bite §7 describes. Dart-style metal jigs and swimbaits — the same family as the Deep Stinger and Point Wilson Dart in your box.

LINGCOD PRIMARY



Deep Sea Jigging — Lingcod from 250 ft in the Pacific

Fishing with Rod · BC

On-the-water BC lingcod jigging with instructional narration — the closest verified BC context, including the steady-retrieve habit that matters when a hitchhiker ling grabs your rockfish.

ALTERNATE



Using a Deepwater Release Device on a Rockfish

Alaska Dept. of Fish & Game · agency demo

A biologist demonstrating a SeaQualizer-style release on a silvergray rockfish — a species you will actually encounter at Hakai. Pairs with §2's descending-device expectation and the yelloweye non-retention rule.

DESCENDER PRIMARY



How to Use a SeaQualizer Descending Device

FWC Saltwater Fishing · agency demo

Clearest device-specific mechanics — depth setting, clipping to a weighted rod. Florida agency, identical technique. (West-coast backup, also verified: Reel West Coast, [Preserve Rockfish Bycatch](#). — no DFO/BC-produced descender video exists that we could find, and the ling-on-a-rockfish trick stays with the guide.)

ALTERNATE

Method. Every link was verified working on 28 July 2026 — exact title and channel confirmed. BC and Pacific-Northwest creators preferred; durations shown only where confirmed; where no genuinely good video exists for a topic, the gap is flagged rather than padded.

Before you leave cell coverage: watch the three essentials — or download them with YouTube Premium. The field guide is the on-the-water reference; this one is homework.

LINKS VERIFIED 28 JULY 2026 · COMPANION TO THE HAKAI
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